

PARENT PLAYBOOK

How to channel a high-energy child: 4 steps

Got a restless child who can't sit still? That energy may be a gift. Here's how to channel a high-energy kid's drive into focus, confidence, and a real strength.

1

Quick answer

4

Action steps

5

Parent FAQs

START HERE

The quick answer

What is a high-energy temperament? Temperament is the inborn style a child reacts with. A high-intensity child feels and moves at full volume - loud, fast, and physical. Handled well, that same intensity grows into enthusiasm, drive, and determination. The energy isn't the problem; an outlet is the solution.

DO THIS

How to channel a high-energy child: 4 steps

Work through these in order. Small, daily reps beat one big push.

1

Burn fuel first

Before homework or anything that needs sitting, give 20-30 minutes of hard play - running, a sport, the park. A tired body makes a calm mind.

2

Find their 'cricket'

Try sports, dance, martial arts, swimming - one real outlet where the energy is the point, not the problem. Let them help pick it.

3

Channel, don't crush

Swap 'stop moving' for 'move here.' Give jobs that use the body: carry, build, deliver, set the table. Energy with a purpose becomes help.

4

Catch the strength, name it

When the drive shows up as effort or courage, say it out loud: 'You don't give up.' Kids grow the qualities we name.

PARENT FAQ

Quick answers

Is my restless child just hyperactive or is it ADHD?

High energy alone isn't ADHD. A high-energy child can still focus and finish a task when it matters to them; a child with ADHD struggles to focus even when they try, across many settings. If focus problems are severe and constant, talk to your doctor - but most restless kids are simply intense by temperament.

How do I calm a restless child down?

Don't start with 'sit still.' Start with movement - 20-30 minutes of hard play burns the fuel, and a tired body settles the mind. Then offer a focused, hands-on task. Calm comes after the energy has somewhere to go, not before.

Is too much energy in a child a bad thing?

No. Handled well, high energy becomes drive, enthusiasm, and determination - the engine behind athletes, founders, and leaders. The energy isn't the problem; a lack of outlet is. Give it a track and it becomes a strength.

What sports are good for a high-energy child?

Any activity where moving is the point: running, football, swimming, cricket, martial arts, dance. The best one is the one your child enjoys enough to stick with, so let them help choose. Consistency matters more than the specific sport.

Will my restless child grow out of it?

The intensity usually stays - but it matures. With a good outlet, that same energy turns into focus and drive as they grow. The aim isn't to erase it but to aim it, so it works for your child instead of against them.

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